



AT&T to replace SMS with RCS

All Android phones will soon be able to send and receive RCS messages, according to AT&T. <https://dgit.in/jul21-90>



Qualcomm branded smartphone?

Qualcomm's first self-branded smartphone, designed by Asus costing \$1,499 is available now. <https://dgit.in/jul21-92>

OnePlus Nord CE 5G

A worthy successor to the mighty Nord?

Launched in 2020, the OnePlus Nord remains one of the best selling phones from the company to date. Now, in 2021, OnePlus is looking to take its mid-range game up a notch with the launch of the Nord CE 5G. Will the OnePlus Nord CE replicate the successes of the original OnePlus Nord. Read our review to find out.

DISPLAY AND DESIGN

With the Nord CE 5G, OnePlus appears to be focussing on the design and display department. We have a device that feels solid in the hands, does not compromise in terms of looks, and to top it off also has an above par display for a mid-range phone.

At 7.9mm, the OnePlus Nord CE 5G is the slimmest OnePlus smartphone since the OnePlus 6T. It's also quite lightweight at 170 grams. The back panel of the phone flaunts a soft matte finish. Unfortunately, unlike the original Nord, this phone misses out on the iconic alert slider. There is also no Gorilla Glass protection on the device.

Talking about the display, we have a 6.3-inch FluidAMOLED panel. This panel is capable of running a maximum resolution of 2400x1800 pixels. This screen is also capable of running at a fast refresh rate of 90Hz.

As one would expect, the performance of the display is quite good. In our time with it, we found the display to match up to our expectations. It can get plenty bright, even under direct sunlight, and also outputs vibrant and punchy colours. The display also hides an in-display fingerprint scanner which is quite responsive and fast.

PERFORMANCE

Underneath the hood, the OnePlus Nord CE 5G brings with itself a Qualcomm Snapdragon 750G chipset, with 5G support, which offers a decent punch in terms of performance. Manu-



Price
₹22,999

BATTERY

Moving on to the battery, the OnePlus Nord CE 5G provided expected results. The phone does just about enough here to hold its own, even if it doesn't go the extra mile to stand out from the crowd. The device comes with a 4,500mAh battery pack. If you're a medium-heavy user, the OnePlus Nord CE 5G should easily get you through a day's use and more.

When you finally find your phone running out of charge, you can simply plug it in the provided Warp Charger 30T charging brick to take it from 0-70 in about 30 minutes.

VERDICT

At Rs 22,999, the Nord CE 5G is a good option if you're looking for a new smartphone that sits in the mid-range segment. However, its biggest problem is the competition that exists in the segment, and its inability to effectively stand out from the crowd. It also looks weak against the original OnePlus Nord, which despite being slightly more expensive, and a year older, looks like the better phone between the two.

—Sushant Talwar

factured using an 8nm process, this chipset offers design similarities to the Snapdragon 765G. OnePlus has paired the phone with 12GB RAM on the top-end variant of the device. As we found during our review, this core hardware comes together to ensure that the phone performs as advertised. While the chipset isn't the most powerful in the business, it still does offer enough power to handle graphically demanding games and heavy applications. The phone is equally adept at multitasking.

This was backed up by the results of the benchmarks we ran. The OnePlus Nord CE 5G scored a respectable 390044 points in AnTuTu. In Geekbench 5, the phone managed a single-core score of 639 points and a multi-core score of 1878 points.

CAMERAS

The device gets a triple-lens set-up, with a primary 64MP lens, with support for electronic image stabilisation (EIS). You also have an 8MP ultrawide lens and a 2MP mono lens. As for performance, the lenses are a bit of a mixed bag. Talking about the primary



BUILD	61
FEATURES	66
PERFORMANCE	65
VALUE	65

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY SIZE: 6.43 inches | DISPLAY RESOLUTION: 2400 x 1080 pixels 410 PPI | DISPLAY TYPE: 90 Hz Fluid AMOLED | OPERATING SYSTEM: OxygenOS based on Android 11 | CPU: Qualcomm Snapdragon 750G | GPU: Adreno 619 | RAM: 6GB/8GB/12GB LPDDR4X | STORAGE: 128GB/256GB UFS2.1 | BATTERY: 4500 mAh, Warp Charge 30T Plus | REAR CAMERAS: 64MP + 8MP + 2MP | SELFIE CAMERA: 16MP | WEIGHT: 170g

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